CURRICULUM VITAE / FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

Elena Rowan

Botanical Illustrator & Editorial Designer

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example.com/elena-rowan • Available for studio and publishing collaborations

Profile

Illustrator and designer translating botanical research into clear, expressive publications. Six years of experience across field guides, museum interpretation, and editorial systems. Combines close observation, patient craft, and practical production skills to make complex subjects inviting.

Experience

Senior Editorial Designer 2023–Present

Fieldnote Studio / Denver, CO

- Lead visual development for illustrated books, exhibition guides, and seasonal publications, from early sketches to press-ready files.
- Built a modular page system for a 240-page regional flora, coordinating 180 illustrations with three contributing botanists.
- Standardized proofing and preflight checklists across a six-person team, reducing average correction rounds from four to two.

Illustrator & Graphic Designer 2020–2023

Juniper Natural History Museum / Boulder, CO

- Created specimen illustrations, interpretive panels, and visitor maps for exhibitions on native plants and pollinator habitats.
- Designed an accessible family field journal used in 24 school workshops, with clear visual prompts and space for observation.
- Prepared color-managed artwork and coordinated production with local printers, fabricators, and the museum education team.

Selected strengths

Illustration Botanical drawing, pen and ink, watercolor, vector artwork.

Design Book typography, information hierarchy, publication systems.

Collaboration Research synthesis, art direction, production handoff.

Observation into form

A selection of projects, study, and shared practice.

Selected projects

Flora of the Front Range 2025

Illustrated field guide / Fieldnote Studio

Designed a portable identification guide with a consistent specimen scale, habitat icons, and a visual index. Developed botanical plates from field sketches and refined diagnostic details with scientific reviewers.

The Pollinator Garden 2024

Exhibition identity / Juniper Museum

Created an illustrated identity and a suite of 18 interpretation panels. Balanced botanical detail with large-format readability and supplied reusable templates for future seasonal updates.

A Cabinet of Seeds 2022

Independent artist's book / Edition of 100

Produced a hand-bound collection pairing fine-line seed drawings with natural-history notes. Managed concept, typography, paper selection, printing, and binding.

Education

BFA, Communication Design 2020

North Valley College of Art

Focus on editorial design, scientific illustration, and print production.

Certificate, Botanical Illustration 2022

Mountain Botanical Arts Program

Advanced study in plant morphology, observational drawing, and watercolor.

Tools & methods

Adobe InDesign, Illustrator, and Photoshop; Affinity Designer; Figma; LaTeX and TikZ; digital asset preparation; print preflight; color proofing.

Builds reusable templates and documented visual standards for collaborative teams.

Teaching & community

Sketching the Seasonal Garden / 2024–Present

Facilitate quarterly drawing sessions for adult beginners, introducing plant structure, field-note habits, and simple ink-and-wash techniques.